

HUJI Applicative Research Report — Exact & Social Sciences — Week 35, 2026

2 paper(s) · Exact & Social Sciences · Weekly · Week 35, 2026 · Generated August 24, 2026

■ ■ There is no high-potential applicable research this period — only lower-scoring papers were found. Presenting the two best below.

The latest research from Hebrew University showcases advancements in both consumer-facing digital health and foundational industrial chemistry. One study introduces innovative AI-driven UI/UX strategies designed to significantly improve long-term adherence to healthy eating habits on online food platforms. Concurrently, another breakthrough reveals a novel class of highly potent metal catalysts, promising more efficient and selective chemical transformations vital for pharmaceutical and fine chemical manufacturing. These diverse innovations represent compelling opportunities across high-growth sectors.

RESEARCHERS & RESEARCH SUBJECTS — BEST AVAILABLE

- Roni Lotan — FoodTech, Software/AI, Other
- Yuri Tulchinsky — Materials, Other

EXACT & SOCIAL SCIENCES — RESEARCH HIGHLIGHTS

1. Beyond one-shot nudges: the effects of repeated interventions for healthier online meal ordering. 22/50

"AI-powered UI/UX software prevents "nudge decay," driving long-term healthy food choices on online platforms."

Main researcher: Roni Lotan

School of Public Policy, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Jerusalem, Israel.; For a Change, Research Lab, Tel Aviv, Israel.

Published · 2026-05

ABOUT THIS RESEARCH

The study investigates how different digital nudges, specifically real-time feedback and assortment changes, influence healthy food choices in online ordering platforms over multiple days. It finds that combining structural changes with moment-of-choice feedback prevents the common 'decay effect' where users revert to old habits, maintaining higher health scores over time.

COMMERCIAL ANGLE

Developing specialized UI/UX behavioral optimization software for food delivery and grocery platforms to drive long-term consumer adherence to nutritional guidelines.

COMMERCIALISATION METRICS

Novelty

4/10

The research applies well-established behavioral economics principles (nudging and assortment) to a known domain, offering incremental insight into temporal decay rather than introducing a novel mechanism or disruptive technology. While the longitudinal focus adds value to digital health strategy, it does not represent a fundamental scientific breakthrough or a new platform-enabling methodology.

Commercial Potential

6/10

The research identifies a specific, implementable UX strategy (combining assortment and feedback) that has direct B2B licensing potential for food delivery platforms looking to improve ESG metrics or user health outcomes. However, it lacks a proprietary technical moat or deep-tech component, functioning more as an optimization playbook for existing digital interfaces.

Market Size

7/10

The target market is massive, encompassing the global digital food delivery and e-commerce sectors where even marginal improvements in consumer choice behavior drive significant commercial value. However, the application is a feature-level optimization rather than a standalone platform, limiting its direct capture of the total addressable market.

Tech Readiness

3/10

The technology is at a fundamental/proof-of-concept stage, utilizing a mock platform and hypothetical orders rather than a live commercial environment. While the behavioral insights are promising, the study lacks integration into real-world transactional systems or large-scale user environments.

IP Strength

2/10

The innovation relies on behavioral economics principles (nudging, assortment, and feedback) which are widely documented in academic literature and are generally considered non-patentable psychological interventions. There is no evidence of a proprietary algorithm, novel software architecture, or unique hardware that would provide a defensible technical moat.

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2. Cationic Sulfonium-Based Tripodal Ligand and Its Rh(I) Complexes.

17/50

"New sulfonium-based catalysts offer unparalleled efficiency for critical chemical and pharmaceutical manufacturing."

Main researcher: Yuri Tulchinsky

Institute of Chemistry, Edmond Safra Campus, Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Jerusalem, Israel.

Published in Chemistry (Weinheim an der Bergstrasse, Germany) · 2026-04

ABOUT THIS RESEARCH

Researchers have developed a new class of cationic sulfonium-based ligands that form highly potent Rhodium(I) complexes. These complexes exhibit extreme Lewis acidity and unique electronic properties compared to traditional phosphorus or silicon-based ligands.

COMMERCIAL ANGLE

The development of highly electrophilic metal catalysts could enable more efficient and selective chemical transformations in fine chemical synthesis and pharmaceutical manufacturing.

COMMERCIALISATION METRICS

Novelty

5/10

The paper introduces a first-of-its-kind cationic sulfonium-based tripodal ligand and explores its fundamental electronic properties, which represents incremental scientific innovation. However, it is a specialized organometallic characterization study rather than a disruptive or platform-enabling discovery with immediate industrial application.

Commercial Potential

3/10

The paper is fundamental organometallic research focusing on ligand design and electronic characterization rather than a specific industrial application or process. While the high Lewis acidity could eventually enable new catalytic processes, the work lacks a defined path toward a commercial product, service, or scalable technology.

Market Size

3/10

The research describes fundamental coordination chemistry and novel ligand design, which lacks a defined commercial application or specific industrial vertical. While scientifically significant, there is no evidence of a direct link to a large-scale market such as catalysis, pharmaceuticals, or materials science.

Tech Readiness

2/10

The research is in the fundamental discovery stage, focusing on basic coordination chemistry, structural characterization, and electronic property elucidation. There is no evidence of application testing, process optimization, or scalability required for higher TRL levels.

IP Strength

4/10

While the paper describes a novel chemical entity with unique electronic properties, it represents fundamental organometallic coordination chemistry rather than a specific industrial application or platform technology. The IP strength is limited by the lack of demonstrated utility in a high-value sector like catalysis, pharmaceuticals, or materials science.

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